

Answer Key

Grade 4 Intermediate Passages

1. The Blocked Drain

1. What is causing the puddle on the path?
A. Leaves packed against the grate are blocking the drain.
2. Why doesn't Jordan lift the grate by himself?
A. It is heavy, and the hole underneath is deep.
3. What happens after they clear the opening?
B. The water drops and the gravel path shows again.

2. The Swollen Lid

1. What is wrong with the time capsule?
C. The damp lid has swollen and will not latch.
2. Why do they reject Owen's first idea?
A. Pressing harder could crack the wood.
3. How do they get the box to close?
A. They dry the open lid in the sun with a fan.

3. Field Day Under Cover

1. Why can't the relay stay on the field?
D. Thunder makes the open field and the metal poles unsafe.
2. How does the race change under the awning?
A. It becomes a shorter track with two legs instead of four.
3. What shows that the new plan works?
C. Jonah's team finishes without dropping the baton.

4. The Wallet on the Bench

1. What does Mateo find, and why is it a problem?
B. A wallet whose owner has already left the playground
2. Why doesn't Mateo search the wallet on the sidewalk?
D. People walking by could watch him go through it.
3. How is the wallet returned?
A. The rec center calls Luis using the ID inside.

5. The Sprinkler's Aim

1. Why is the lettuce drooping?
D. The sprinkler has been watering the path, so the soil is dry.
2. How do they water once they know the soil is dry?
B. Slowly, at the roots, without turning the bed to mud
3. What does the watering map prevent?
B. Another week of watering the path instead of the plants

6. The Stuck Scale

1. What is wrong at the bake sale?
D. The scale sticks at four ounces for every muffin.
2. How does Priya prove the scale is the problem?
B. A known weight still shows up as four ounces.
3. What does she do so nobody uses the bad scale?
C. She tapes a do-not-use note on it and prices with the other scale.

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7. The Sagging Bridge

1. What must Leo's bridge do at the fair?
A. Hold three books without touching the table
2. Why doesn't more glue solve the sag?
C. It makes the deck heavier without stopping the fold.
3. What change lets the bridge pass?
B. Cardboard triangles glued under the deck

8. Before the Truck

1. What problem does Sofia find on Thursday?
B. Cans and paper are in the wrong recycling bins.
2. Why does she sort on Thursday instead of Friday?
B. The truck sometimes arrives before Friday morning.
3. How does she keep next week from starting mixed?
D. She clips a picture card above each bin.

9. North on the Map

1. What is wrong with Mei's garden map?
C. The north arrow points toward the parking lot.
2. Why was the first compass reading unreliable?
C. Mei used it beside a metal cart.
3. How does Mei know the new arrow is right?
B. A classmate who did not draw the map finds the shed.

10. The Late Handoff

1. Why does Hector's team drop the baton?
A. He calls too late, so his teammate looks back.
2. What does the filmed exchange show?
D. The call comes when Hector is already beside her.
3. What new call do they use?
B. Stick, at the start of the passing zone

11. A Cold Rise

1. Why doesn't the dough rise?
B. An open window has made the kitchen too cold.
2. What does his grandmother change?
B. She warms the bowl above the stove and covers it.
3. What does Sam add to the recipe card?
C. A note about a warm spot, a damp towel, and a shut window

12. The Creek as a Guide

1. What problem does the group have at the fork?
A. The map is lost, and both paths look possible.
2. What information does Rosa use instead of the map?
C. The ranger said the creek stays on the left.
3. How does Rosa keep from losing the next map?
D. She zips the spare into the pocket on her pack.

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13. Case in the Closet

1. What is Diego missing before the concert?
B. His trumpet case
2. Where does he find the case?
B. On the closet floor, shoved back by a cart
3. Why does he stop storing the case on the bench?
D. A rolling cart can shove it off the bench and into the closet.

14. Juice on the Chapter

1. What happened to Lila's library book?
B. Juice soaked a chapter and blurred the ink.
2. Why does Lila pay for a replacement?
C. Damaged library books have to be replaced.
3. How does she still finish the report on time?
D. She checks out a different book about bridges.

15. Short Passes

1. Why are long passes a problem?
D. They stop in the mud and give the ball away.
2. What does Malik ask the team to do?
D. Pass short and stay out of the deep puddle
3. What is the result of the new plan?
B. A short passing move leads to a tying goal.

16. The Silent Filter

1. What clue tells Andre something is wrong?
D. The fish stay at the surface and the filter is silent.
2. Why is the filter rinsed in tank water?
B. Soap would harm the fish.
3. What does Andre add to the job list, and why?
A. Check the hum, because a quiet filter means trouble.

17. One Practice Short

1. What problem hits the play on the day of the show?
C. The lead loses her voice just before the performance.
2. Why can Camila try the part?
D. She has been mouthing the lines from the side at practice.
3. What does Camila learn from getting through the show?
B. Paying attention offstage was practice for the real part.

18. The Switched Bags

1. What does Amir realize at the kitchen table?
C. He took Andre's backpack and left his own, with the tablet, on the bus.
2. How do the boys get the bags back?
D. They meet at the office and trade while Ms. Nguyen watches.
3. What does the ribbon help Amir do?
C. Check the tag before he gets off the bus

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19. After the Heavy Rain

1. What happened to the ripe tomatoes?
D. Heavy rain split their skins.
2. Which tomatoes does the group pick?
B. Only the split ones
3. Why does Ivy write a note on the clipboard?
A. So the club will pick ripe fruit after the next heavy rain

20. A Way for the Cart

1. What problem does the step cause?
D. The supply cart cannot roll over it.
2. Why does the board need to be long?
A. A short board would make the ramp too steep.
3. How do they know the ramp is safe to use?
A. They test an empty tub before the full water jug.

21. Notes on the Floor

1. What happens to the math team's notes?
A. A draft blows them off the bleachers and some get smeared.
2. How can they rebuild the middle steps?
C. They remember the puzzle because they built it.
3. What does Noah do with the new cards after the assembly?
D. He clips them into his folder.

22. Before the Copies

1. What mistake is about to be copied?
B. The article lists Thursday instead of Tuesday.
2. Why can they still fix the file easily?
B. Mr. Patel has not started the copier yet.
3. What habit does Jade start after this?
D. She reads every article once more before it is copied.

23. The Missing Page

1. What is missing from Nina's folder?
A. The page with the key change
2. How does she replace the page?
D. Ms. Brooks copies page 3 from Ben's complete folder.
3. Why does she number the pages afterward?
D. A quick glance had not shown her the page was gone.

24. Cracked Goggles

1. What stops Ben from starting the experiment?
B. A crack in his goggles breaks the safety rule.
2. What does he do before anyone pours?
C. He shows Ms. Ortiz and switches to a spare pair.
3. Why does he label the cracked pair?
A. So it will not be put back with the good goggles

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25. Too Wide for the Board

1. What is the problem with the poster?
A. It is wider than the bulletin board.
2. Why don't they fold the edges or cut through the drawings?
A. Folding hides arrows, and cutting drawings would remove labels.
3. What do they actually cut off?
B. Only the blank margin

26. Bills Stuck Together

1. What does the first count suggest?
A. The store is three dollars short of the price list.
2. What does Luis discover when he separates the bills?
D. Two fives were stuck together and counted as one.
3. How does he keep the same mistake from happening again?
C. He fans the bills before he adds them.

27. Two Different Piles

1. What goes wrong in the practice round?
C. The team reads an against card during the for speech.
2. How do they sort the cards?
C. They mark for cards green and against cards yellow.
3. What happens to the card that fits neither side?
A. They set it aside instead of forcing it into a pile.

28. The Tipped Gauge

1. Why is Cole unsure about the two-inch reading?
C. The gauge is tilted, so the water line is crooked.
2. How does he get a reading he can trust?
A. He stands the gauge up and pours the water into a straight cup.
3. What keeps the gauge from tipping again?
C. A stake stops it from leaning on the fence.

29. The Second Try

1. What goes wrong in Amina's first practice?
C. She rushes and stumbles on the word donations.
2. What change helps her say the word?
A. She pauses after each sentence.
3. Why does she save the marked script?
C. So the next announcement is not her first time at the microphone

30. Labels on the Rocks

1. What is wrong with Omar's display?
B. The sandstone and granite labels are on the wrong rocks.
2. How does he decide which label is correct?
A. He repeats the scratch test and checks it against his notes.
3. Why does he tape labels on the bottom too?
A. So a bump cannot swap them again